



Common, but uncommonly secure!

it's bad. It's not enough to give you an all-encompassing secure environment like Tails but the OS would be enough to secure your system, as long as your security requirements are regular. You will need to keep the OS updated with available patches using the distribution's Update manager. Also, you can make things more secure by adding programs like OpenPGP or Tor.

Make use of Security-Enhanced Linux(SELinux)

There exists a Linux Kernel security module called Security-Enhanced Linux or SELinux. It provides a means by which you can assign security policies for different software, limiting how much data they can access and the functions they can perform.

The users and roles in SELinux needn't be related to the actual system users and roles. For each current user of process, SELinux will assign a three string context which contains a username, role and domain. Usually, most of the actual users will share the same SELinux username while all access control is managed via the third tag- the domain. You can use the command 'runcon' to launch a process into a clearly specified context(user, role and domain). However, SELinux may deny the transition if it hasn't been approved by policy. Separate measures to protect system integrity (basically the domain type) and data confidentiality is one of the key features of SELinux.

SELinux comes as a part of RHEL Verison 4 and subsequent releases. The supported policy in RHEL4 is not that restrictive, since a key objective is to bring in the maximum ease of use.

Methods for securing the Linux server

Encrypt data communication

It's common knowledge that any data transmitted over a network can be monitored. However, it's unfortunately not a common enough practice to encrypt the transmitted data using passwords or keys/certificates. You shouldn't make the same mistake.

Encrypt data communication whenever it's needed or possible. You can use ssh, scp, rsync or sftp to transfer files. It's also possible to mount remote server file system or a home directory with the aid of special sshfs